

A CODE OF CONDUCT FOR SCHOOL BOARD MEMBERS

To promote the highest ethical standards of governance and therein to build and sustain the public trust, the Loudoun County School Board delineates the following Code of Conduct to be upheld by each of its members.

A. As a member of my local School Board, representing all residents of Loudoun County, I recognize:

1. That the residents of Loudoun County have entrusted me with the educational development of the children and youth of this community.

2. That the public expects my first and greatest concern to be in the best interest of each and every one of these young people without distinction as to who they are or what their background may be.

3. That the future welfare of this community, of this State, and of the Nation depends in the largest measure upon the quality of education we provide in the public schools to fit the needs of every learner.

4. That my fellow board members and I shall take the initiative in helping the people of this community to have the facts about their schools, to the end that they will provide the best possible school program, school staff, and school facilities.

5. That legally the authority of the Board is derived from the State which ultimately controls the organization and operation of the school district and which determines the degree of discretionary power left with the Board and the people of this community for the exercise of local autonomy.

6. That I must never neglect my personal obligation to the community and my legal obligation to the State, nor surrender these responsibilities to any other person, group, or organization; but that, beyond these, I have a moral and civic obligation to the Nation which can remain strong and free only so long as public schools in the United States of America are kept free and strong.

7. That the Loudoun County School Board is a public body and that its business shall be conducted in public in accordance with the open meetings requirements of the Virginia Freedom of Information Act (VFOIA), Va. Code § 2.2-3700 *et seq.*

B. In view of the foregoing consideration, it shall be my constant endeavor:

1. To regularly attend and fully participate in all scheduled board meetings, including those of committees to which I am assigned, and to otherwise devote sufficient time, thought, and study to the duties and responsibilities of a school board member so that I may render effective and creditable service to my constituents and to the school district as a whole.

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2. To recognize that it is as important for the Board to understand and evaluate the educational program of the schools as it is to plan for the business of school operation, and thus it shall be my duty to thoroughly research all issues to the best of my ability so that my decisions may be in the best interests of my constituents and the school district as a whole.

3. To show respect for and work with my fellow board members and staff in a spirit of harmony and cooperation in spite of differences of opinion that arise during vigorous debate of points at issue.

4. To respect the stated purpose for, and maintain the confidentiality of, discussions that are held pursuant to the Code of Virginia as closed meetings.

5. To base my personal decision upon all available facts in each situation and to vote my honest conviction in every case, un-swayed by bias of any kind.

6. To remember at all times that as an individual I have no legal authority outside the meetings of the Board, and to conduct my relationships with the school staff, the local residents, and all media of communication on the basis of this fact.

7. To resist every temptation and outside pressure to use my position as a school board member to benefit either myself or any other individual or agency apart from the total interest of the school district.

8. To bear in mind under all circumstances that the primary function of the Board is to establish the policies by which the schools are to be administered, but that the administration of the educational program and conduct of school business shall be left to the employed superintendent of schools and their staff.

9. To welcome and encourage active cooperation by Loudoun County residents, organizations, and the media of communication in the district with respect to establishing policy on current school operation and proposed future developments.

10. Finally, to strive step by step toward ideal conditions for most effective school board service to my community, in a spirit of teamwork and devotion to public education as the greatest instrument for the preservation of perpetuation of our representative democracy.

[Former Policy 2-2]

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